

HB 1867 -- TRANSIENT GUEST TAXES

SPONSOR: Roberts

COMMITTEE ACTION: Voted "Do Pass" by the Standing Committee on Local Government by a vote of 15 to 1. Voted "Do Pass" by the Standing Committee on Rules-Administrative by a vote of 9 to 0.

Currently, a number of cities and counties are authorized by statute to impose a tax on charges paid by transient guests of hotels and motels of up to 5% per occupied room per night. The proceeds of this tax are to be used solely for funding a convention and visitors bureau.

This bill allows one city included in the authorization described above to, upon voter approval, increase this authorized tax to up to 6% per occupied room per night. The proceeds of an increase authorized by this bill must be used by the city for the construction and maintenance of new capital projects to promote tourism.

Upon enactment, this bill will apply to Joplin.

PROPONENTS: Supporters say that this bill would allow the City of Joplin to fund, without a state appropriation, a revitalization project for a cherished local landmark that will preserve the city's history and grow the local economy.

Testifying in person for the bill were Representative Roberts; Clifford Wert; Melodee Colbert Kean; and Robert L. Harrington.

OPPONENTS: There was no opposition voiced to the committee.

Written testimony has been submitted for this bill. The full written testimony and witnesses testifying online can be found under Testimony on the bill page on the House website.